

Go-to-Market Strategy

Lean customer acquisition and launch plan

Ireland first Founding 100 Community-led

1 GTM decision

Launch to **self-coached recreational lifters who follow structured 8–12 week strength or hypertrophy blocks, already track sets/RPE, and use a wearable or detailed log**. Do not market “AI fitness coaching.” Market one repeated outcome:

Turn the session plan, last comparable work and recovery trend into one explainable decision—Progress, Repeat, Reduce or Defer—that the athlete approves.

The model is freemium with a 21-day reverse trial, Athlete at €79/year or €8.99/month, and a later coach-sponsored tier. Distribution must therefore prove repeated pre-session use before paid scale.

1.1 Channel principle

Acquire through **borrowed trust first**, owned audience second, product referral third. Defer broad paid social until retention and contribution margin are credible. RevenueCat’s 2026 dataset covers 115,000+ subscription apps and reports a Western Europe median D35 conversion of 2.0%; it also finds AI apps monetise better per payer but churn faster.[2] The implication is disciplined cohort learning, not install volume.

2 Three customer-acquisition strategies

1 Coach, club and micro-creator design-partner pods	
Why it fits	One trusted relationship recruits a concentrated cohort and can observe whether the product improves a real programming conversation. It reduces cold consumer CAC and creates credible evidence without requiring an endorsement.
Real tactics	Build a 50-prospect Irish list. Send 10 personalised messages weekly. Recruit 8–12 coaches, powerlifting clubs, CrossFit boxes and evidence-led micro-creators; each nominates 5–10 qualified lifters for a 21-day Decision Sprint. Give a cohort code, onboarding pack, weekly consent-safe insight summary and co-branded result card.
Primary metric	Activated athletes per partner and week-4 retained cohort.

2 Community-led evidence content + lead magnet	
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Why it fits	The audience already debates autoregulation, readiness and RPE. The evidence-card workflow is demonstrable and useful content can earn moderator permission where promotional link-dumping would fail. Sport Ireland reported record weekly participation of 49% in 2024, with teenagers and young adults the highest-participating groups.[1]
Real tactics	Publish one weekly “Decision Breakdown”: planned session → last comparable set → recovery trend → bounded decision → what would change it. Repurpose into a 45-second video, carousel and email. Offer a one-page “5-Minute Session Decision Card”; qualify by active block, sessions/week and tracking method.
Primary metric	Qualified applications per breakdown and lead-magnet-to-activation rate.

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Outcome-qualified product referral

Why it fits	Evidence cards are naturally shareable and lifters train in peer groups. Rewarding completed sessions rather than sign-ups filters low-intent traffic and makes referral contingent on real product value.
Real tactics	Trigger only after two proposals and one recorded outcome. Give both people 30 days of Athlete Plus when the invitee completes two sessions. Provide a redacted “decision receipt” with evidence labels and counterfactual; sensitive values are hidden by default. Cap rewards and monitor abuse.
Primary metric	Activated referred users and retained referred users—not invites sent.

3 Best launch channels

Rank	Channel	Role in the funnel	Use now?
1	Founder-led coach/club/creator outreach	Qualify, recruit pods, learn objections and seed trust.	Yes — primary
2	Partner WhatsApp, email and member groups	Activate cohorts and maintain accountability close to training.	Yes — primary
3	Instagram Reels / YouTube Shorts / LinkedIn carousels	Show the evidence-card moment and create partner credibility.	Yes — organic
4	Owned landing page + email	Capture qualification, consent, nurture and launch conversion.	Yes — system
5	SEO articles	Own high-intent questions over time; repurpose validated objections.	Later — compound
6	Meta/TikTok paid and app stores	Creative testing and scale only after retained economics.	Defer

4 Early traction system

4.1 Founding 100 waitlist

Offer 100 Ireland-first places to structured lifters. The landing page has one CTA—**Apply for beta**—and asks block type, sessions/week, current log and recovery source. Rank by fit, not arrival time. Avoid false scarcity or unverified counters.

4.2 21-day Decision Sprint

After the first context-ready snapshot, provide 21 days of Athlete without a card. Commitment: three planned sessions, two reviewed decisions and one recorded outcome. RevenueCat reports 17+ day trials converting 70% better than short trials in its dataset, supporting a window long enough for this multi-session product to demonstrate value.[2]

4.3 Session Decision Card lead magnet

Give the worksheet immediate standalone value: block goal, last comparable work, recovery trend, constraints and a Progress / Repeat / Reduce / Defer decision. Invite qualified users to submit one redacted card for priority beta review. The nurture sequence then shows the workflow becoming faster, stored and auditable.

5 Six-week lean execution

Week	Ship / do	Exit signal
1	Landing page, qualification form, lead magnet, events and 50-prospect list.	Tracking works; 10 highly matched prospects ready.
2	Ten interviews/demos; recruit first three pods; publish two breakdowns.	At least three cohort commitments or clear objection pattern.
3	Onboard 20–30 design partners; daily activation support.	Most can reach first decision without founder rescue.
4	Expand toward 50 users; launch outcome-qualified referral; publish one approved case note.	Two-proposal use and outcomes are measurable by source.
5	Fill Founding 100; open 21-day reverse trial; send segmented nurture.	Qualified demand exceeds places; no activation collapse.
6	Analyse cohorts; invite best-fit users to €79 founder offer.	Decide repeat, narrow, price-test or stop paid expansion.

6 Funnel targets and decision gates

Stage	Working target	Interpretation
Partner outbound	50 → 15 → 8	Prospects → positive replies → calls; diagnose message and segment fit.

Stage	Working target	Interpretation
Pod recruitment	8 calls → 3 pods	Sufficient for 20 activated athletes without broad reach.
Founding 100	100 qualified	A deliberately filtered beta, not an vanity-email count.
Activation	70 snapshots	Context-ready snapshot is the true onboarding completion.
Repeated value	50 users	Two reviewed proposals indicate more than demo curiosity.
Outcome	35 users	Recorded outcome makes trust and usefulness measurable.
Paid founder offer	20 users	A price signal; not proof of scalable CAC.

Continue community/partner acquisition if at least 50% of activated athletes review two proposals and at least 35% record an outcome. **Test paid creative** only when a source cohort retains through week 8 and expected gross contribution exceeds CAC. **Do not launch the coach workspace** until two coaches have live athletes and a recurring review queue.

7 Lean-team operating cadence

The founder owns partner outreach, community permission, interviews and weekly cohort review. One content/design generalist turns each Decision Breakdown into video, carousel and email. Product engineering owns attribution, activation events and the referral trigger. Hold a 30-minute growth review twice weekly: source → snapshot → proposal two → outcome → paid offer. Stop any activity that produces reach without qualified snapshots.

8 References

- [1] Sport Ireland, “Sport participation hits record high of 49%,” 3 April 2025.
- [2] RevenueCat, State of Subscription Apps 2026; 115,000+ apps and more than USD 16bn in revenue.
- [3] Mailchimp, Email Marketing Benchmarks; all-user open/click context and methodology.

Internal basis: all supplied positioning, validation, competitive, workflow and challenge documents, plus the latest Core Products, Development Plan, Sprint Plan, Business Model and Business Model Canvas were reviewed. Targets are testable operating hypotheses, not forecasts.